BOOKLET

FOR

PRIMARY SCHOOL ENGLISH PAPER

EDUCATION IS THE KEY TO EVERYTHING

LOVE IT, LIVE IT

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BOOKLET FOR PRIMARY SCHOOL ENGLISH PAPER

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PREFACE

This booklet is intended to give primary school teachers a picture of areas to put much effort in teaching, learning and assessing of English subject in primary schools in preparation for national examinations as well as equipping learners with skills in writing, speaking and comprehension of English subject and other subjects that are taught in English language.

This booklet can be used by both teachers and learners because it is presented in simple and easy-to-understand words.

The author thought of writing this booklet after observing challenges that teachers, especially newly recruited ones, face in teaching and assessing learners in the subject of English. Therefore this will give chance to old and new teachers to deliver and assess their lessons of English subject effectively and efficiently.

PRIMARY SCHOOL EDUCATION

DOOR TO BRIGHT FUTURE

MARKING SCHEME

INFORMAL/FRIENDLY LETTER

Sender's address	2 marks
Date	1 mark
Salutation	1 mark
Introduction	1 mark
Paragraphing	3 marks
Conclusion	1 mark
Ending	1 mark
Length	2 marks
FOI/sequence	2 marks

FORMAL/BUSINESS LETTER

Sender's address	2 marks
Date	1 mark
Receiver's address	2 marks
Salutation	1 mark
Title	2 marks
Introduction	1 mark
Paragraphing	3 marks
Conclusion	1 mark
Ending	1 mark
Length	2 marks
FOI/sequence	2 marks

COMPOSITION

Title	1 or 2 marks
Introduction	1 mark
Paragraphing	3 marks
Conclusion	1 mark
Length	2 marks
FOI/sequence	3 marks

(Title is 1 mark when it is given and title is 2 marks when it is generated by a learner)

ENGLISH PAPER SECTIONS

English paper is in four areas (sections)

SECTION A (30 marks)

- Letter writing or composition
- Each point in a paragraph should be given marks according to its significance

SECTION B (20 marks)

- Comprehension

SECTION C (10 marks)

- Punctuation
- Direct and indirect speech
- Active and passive voices
- Antonyms (opposite)
- Synonyms (same meaning)
- Signalling devices
- Sentence construction

SECTION D (40 marks)

This section contains multiple choice questions.

- Parts of speech
- Question tags
- Phrases
- Clauses
- Phrasal verbs
- Conditional sentences
- Figures of speech (Similes, metaphors)
- Proverbs
- Idioms
- Parsing (dividing a sentence)
- Vocabulary (comparison of adjectives, adverbs, prepositions, and so forth)

PRIMARY SCHOOL ENGLISH PAPER

SECTION A (30 marks)

LETTER WRITING (FRIENDLY AND BUSINESS) AND COMPOSITION, (SPEECH AND REPORT).

A. SENDER'S ADDRESS

How to write:

- There should be no punctuation marks because it should be BLOCK type of address.
- There should be no abbreviations
- Proper gauging of where to start/begin the address
- Begin each word with a capital letter in the address
- Skip a line before writing a date

B. DATE

- Skip a line from the address
- Proper ways: 27th March, 2013.
  March 27th, 2013.

C. RECEIVER'S (RECIPIENT'S) ADDRESS

- No punctuations
- Skip a line
- Begin each word with a capital letter
- Acknowledge the receiver's title
- No abbreviations

D. SALUTATION

- In business letter
  - Dear Sir,
  - Dear Madam,
  - (one of the two not **both**)
- The word Dear should begin from the margin
- A comma after Sir or Madam

E. TITLE/HEADLINE/HEADING

- Should begin from the margin
- Skip a line
- There are two ways of writing the title:
  (i) All in CAPITAL LETTERS (not underlined)
  (ii) Begin each word with a capital letter and underline

F. INTRODUCTION

- Jump (skip) a line
- Should begin from the margin
- Write introduction related to a theme you want to write
- Examples of how to start:
  - In my composition I am going to explain about the general cleaning at our market.
  - I would like to inform you that our class went to the nearest market to help in cleaning it.
  - It should be part of **paragraph 1**.

G. MAIN BODY

- Questions should be answered in full taking into account the paragraphs.

H. CONCLUSION

- Should be related to the main idea (theme) of the letter or composition
- Conclusion should be part of **paragraph 3**.
- For example:
  - This is all that I wanted to write.

I. ENDING

- Examples: Your son, daughter, and so forth, if it is friendly
- Use 'Yours faithfully', 'Yours sincerely' if it is business letter
- 'Yours' should begin from the margin
- Put a comma after faithfully or sincerely
- NB: one address one name, two addresses two names
- Skipping a line or not between 'Yours faithfully' and a 'name' is optional

Yours faithfully, Chimwemwe Banda.	Yours faithfully, Chimwemwe Banda.	Your nephew, Chimwemwe.	Your nephew, Chimwemwe.

J. PARAGRAPHING

- The letter or composition should have three paragraphs as required
- And begin each paragraph from a margin
- Jump a line to begin a new paragraph

K. LENGTH

- Write number of words as required

L. FLOW OF IDEAS(FOI)/SEQUENCE

- Ideas should be written in their correct order

M. ERRORS

i. Wrong tense
ii. Wrong capitalisation
iii. Wrong or no punctuation marks
iv. Wrong sentence construction
v. Word combination
vi. Word parting
vii. Figuring (1 to 99 in words) (100 onwards in figures, except date)
viii. Jumbled ideas
ix. Wrong spelling
x. Word omission

(remove half (½) mark for each error made. However, when ½ mark has been deducted for an error, do not deduct another mark for the same error)

HOW TO TEACH SPEECH

Speech has the following components:

- ✓ Title
- ✓ Salutation
- ✓ Introduction
- ✓ Body
- ✓ Conclusion
- ✓ Ending

TITLE

Though, when presenting a speech you don't read a title but it is necessary for a speech to have a title. In exams, a title may be given or may not be given so it is necessary to train learners how they can come up with a good title when not given.

A title may be written in two ways and these are:

- ✓ Block letters
  When it is written in Block letters, it is not supposed to be underlined.

- ✓ Small letters
  When it is written in small letters, it is supposed to be underlined. However, the first letter of the sentence must be capitalized.

SALUTATION

In a speech, salutation means recognizing the ones who are listening to the speech. The recognition should follow order of power or authority. Normally the guest of honour is recognized first.

In a primary school speech, recognized person or group of people should be written in its own line. It is supposed to be written from the margin.

For example;

The Headteacher

The school committee chairperson

The Village heads

All leaders gathered here

My fellow learners

Ladies and gentlemen

Learners can punctuate the salutation if they are trained thoroughly however learners are not forced to do so. Therefore, considering that we deal with learners of different levels of understanding then salutation should be written without punctuations.

INTRODUCTION

Introduction is very vital in all contexts. Introduction paints a picture of what is going to be said in the main body. In a speech, the introduction is there with minor changes or additions as compared to composition or letter. In a speech, an introduction must have a minimum of two sentences. The first sentence shows gratitude for being given an opportunity to speak on behalf of other people or fellow learners. The second sentence gives an overview of what is going to be said in the main body.

It should be a stand-alone paragraph.

For example;
It gives me a lot of pleasure to stand in front of you to make a speech on behalf of my fellow learners. I would like to highlight some of the problems we are currently facing……

BODY

I will not say much on this because it is the same with letter writing, composition, and so forth. However, learners should use personal pronouns or should tell from first point of view.

CONCLUSION

Conclusion is very important as it wraps up what has been said. It can be part of paragraph 3.

ENDING

To end the speech, the salutation is repeated but this time in a general way.

For example;

Our guest of honour, ladies and gentleman, I thank you for your attention.

LEARN EXAMINATIONS BOARD

SAMPLE ENGLISH PAPER

(100 marks)

Name of candidate: _____
Time allowed: 2 hours 15 minutes
Instructions

- Answer all questions
- Read **all** instructions on each section

Section A (30 marks)

There are two questions in Section A. Answer **one** question only from this section. Write between **100** and **150** words.

EITHER

1. Imagine that you had an interesting school trip to a game reserve. Write a composition entitled **An unforgettable trip to a game reserve**.
   In your composition include the following points:

   Paragraph 1
   - who organized the trip
   - when the trip took place
   - who you went there with
   - why the trip was made

   Paragraph 2
   - how you travelled to the game reserve
   - who welcomed you at the game reserve
   - **three** interesting things you saw at the game reserve

   Paragraph 3
   - **two** lessons you learnt from the trip
   - why the trip is unforgettable

OR

2. Write a letter to your friend informing him or her about your unforgettable journey. In your letter you may include the following points:

   Paragraph 1
   - Where did you go?
   - How did you travel?
   - What was the purpose of that journey?

Paragraph 2

- People involved in that journey
- Interesting things you saw along the journey (any two).

Paragraph 3

- What you enjoyed at the place you visited.

Section B (20 marks)

3. Read the following passage carefully and answer the questions that follow.

Vinjeru and Mtendere were twins. They lived with their father and mother in Chikopa village. The family had many sheep, goats and cattle. Near their home, there was a big river.

Vinjeru and Mtendere went to school with other children. Their teacher encouraged them to keep the school grounds clean. She also told them to keep rivers clean.

"You should not throw rubbish into the river because it makes the water dirty. Do not swim in fast flowing river because the water can easily carry you away," the teacher advised.

On Saturdays, Vinjeru and Mtendere looked after the animals. One Saturday, they went to the river where there was some pasture. As the animals were grazing, the boys stood on the river bank. "Wow! The river is flowing gently here," Mtendere said. "Yes, and the water is clean. I feel like jumping in," said Vinjeru.

"So do I. why don't we swim a little?" Mtendere suggested. They quickly undressed and put their clothes under a tree. The boys soon forgot about the animals. They swam and played in the river.

The animals went into Mrs. Pangani's maize garden and started eating the maize. The boys' father saw the animals in the garden and quickly drove them out. He saw his sons swimming in the river. He was very angry and took their clothes away. He led the animals home.

Later, Vinjeru looked out from the river. He could not see any cattle, sheep or goat. He was afraid. At once the boys got out of the river. Their clothes were not there. They looked everywhere but could not find them. They waited in the bush until it got dark and ran home naked. When they reached home they heard the cattle mooing, "Moo! Moo!" The boys were happy but ashamed of themselves.

They ran to the house and found their mother standing at the door. She was holding their clothes and looked at them sadly. Their father looked at them angrily. The boys apologized for what had happened.

Questions

a. What was the name of Vinjeru's brother? (1 mark)

_____

b. What **two** pieces of advice did the teacher give the children at school?

(i) _____ (1 mark)

(ii)_____ (1 mark)

c. Give a reason why the boys took the animals to the river. (2 marks)

_____

d. In whose maize garden were the animals eating? (1 mark)

_____

e. Where were the boys when their clothes were picked by their father? (2 marks)

_____

f. Why did father take away the boys' clothes? (2 marks)

_____

g. What made the boys get out of the river? (2 marks)

_____

h. How did the boys feel when they reached home? (2 marks)

_____

i. Why did the boys' mother look at them sadly? (2 marks)

_____

j. Find a word in

(i) **paragraph 2** of the passage that means 'tidy' (1 mark)

_____

(ii) **paragraph 6** of the passage that means 'annoyed' (1 mark)

_____

k. Suggest a title for this story. (2 marks)

_____

Section C (10 marks)

Change each of the following sentences from **direct speech** to **indirect speech**. Write your answers in the spaces provided.

4. "Don't drive the cattle away," pleaded the boy. (1 mark)

_____

5. "The bus has just arrived," Chimwemwe said. (1 mark)

_____

6. "What time is it?" the man asked. (1 mark)

_____

7. "Your father was here yesterday," he said. (1 mark)

_____

8. Jayne said, "I am going home today." (1 mark)

_____

Make sentences using the following words to show that you understand their meanings.

9. join (1 mark)

_____

10. hat (1 mark)

_____

11. kind (1 mark)

_____

12. work (1 mark)

_____

13. quickly (1 mark)

_____

Section D (40 marks)
Questions 14 to **23**

In each of the following questions choose the words (**A, B, C** or **D**) that **best completes** the sentence.

14. The sick baby was taken _____ the hospital for treatment.
    A. at B. to
    C. by D. in
15. The car broke _____ on the way to the hospital.
    A. away B. up
    C. down D. off
16. The village chief strongly advised the youths to abstain _____ smoking.
    A. at B. to
    C. from D. in
17. The boys prefer football _____ basketball.
    A. for B. against
    C. with D. to
18. He asked if he _____ see the class teacher.
    A. could B. can
    C. will D. would
19. If it rains, the village meeting _____ be cancelled.
    A. would B. will
    C. could D. might
20. We would have been told if he _____ a present.
    A. send B. sent
    C. has sent D. had sent
21. If you imitate me, you _____ English well.
    A. will speak B. would speak
    C. speak D. would have spoken
22. I am looking _____ to another event of a similar nature.
    A. up B. over
    C. down D. forward
23. He would find me if he _____ early.
    A. comes B. coming
    C. come D. came

Questions 24 to **33**
In each of the following questions, choose the **correct part of speech** (**A, B, C** or **D**) for each of the underlined words.

24. A bird with a <u>broken</u> wing fell off the tree.
    A. verb B. adjective
    C. adverb D. noun
25. There is a small garden <u>behind</u> the house.
    A. preposition B. conjunction
    C. adverb D. adjective
26. I heard a <u>shout</u> from our neighbour's house.
    A. verb B. adjective
    C. interjection D. noun
27. Why did you do <u>that</u>?
    A. adjective B. pronoun
    C. adverb D. preposition
28. <u>Hurrah!</u> Our school has won a trophy.
    A. adverb B. adjective
    C. conjunction D. interjection
29. Alinafe <u>hurt</u> her leg badly.
    A. noun B. adjective
    C. verb D. adverb
30. The little boy is <u>very</u> excited.
    A. preposition B. adjective
    C. verb D. adverb
31. You must go home <u>because</u> it will soon be dark.
    A. conjunction B. preposition
    C. pronoun D. adjective
32. All of us must do <u>something</u> to stop the spread of HIV.
    A. adverb B. pronoun
    C. preposition D. noun
33. <u>If</u> you run fast, you will find him.
    A. conjunction B. pronoun
    C. preposition D. adverb

Questions 34 to **43**
In each of the following questions, choose the **correct question tag (A, B, C** or **D)** for the statement.

34. Mr. Ngozo is my teacher, _____?
A. is he B. isn't he
C. was he D. wasn't he

35. He repairs his bicycle under this tree, _____?
A. doesn't he B. did he
C. does he D. didn't he

36. Cheating does not pay, _____?
A. is it B. isn't it
C. doesn't it D. does it

37. There are many people in the house, _____?
A. were there B. weren't there
C. aren't there D. are there

38. You have not closed the door, _____?
A. haven't you B. hadn't you
C. have you D. had you

39. They are good friends, _____?
A. aren't they B. are there
C. were they D. weren't they

40. John and Mary went to the party, _____?
A. did they B. didn't he
C. didn't she D. didn't they

41. I am a boy, _____?
A. aren't I B. amn't I
C. am I D. are I

42. John does not go to school, _____?
A. does he B. does she
C. doesn't she D. doesn't he

43. The earth is round, _____?
A. was it B. are it
C. isn't it D. is it

Questions 44 to **48**

In each of the following questions, choose the word (**A, B, C** or **D)** that **best completes** the proverb.

44. There is no _____ without fire.
A. wood B. charcoal
C. kitchen D. smoke

45. The early _____ catches the worm.
A. chicken B. bird
C. crow D. woman

46. Once beaten _____ shy.
A. twice B. thrice
C. two D. zero

47. Every _____ has a silver lining.
A. cloud B. car
C. plane D. president

48. Blood is thicker than _____.
A. oil B. petrol
C. water D. glue

Questions 49 to **53**

In each of the following questions, choose the answer (**A, B, C** or **D**) that gives the **correct type of clause** and **its function.** The clause has been underlined.

49. The story <u>I heard about Tasungana</u> was not true.
A. noun clause, subject of 'was not'
B. noun clause, in apposition to 'story'
C. adjective clause, qualifying 'story'
D. adverb clause, modifying 'was not true'

50. <u>Although she is shy</u>, she is the best in class.
A. adverb clause, modifying 'is'
B. noun clause, object of 'is'
C. noun clause, complement of 'is'
D. noun clause, subject of 'is'

51. They usually eat <u>whatever we prepare</u>.
A. adverb clause, modifying 'usually eat'
B. noun clause, object of 'eat'
C. noun clause, complement of 'eat'
D. adjective clause, qualifying 'usually eat'

52. That was <u>what the team deserved</u>.
A. adverb clause, modifying 'was'
B. noun clause, object of 'was'
C. noun clause, object of 'that'
D. noun clause, complement of 'was'

53. This is the time <u>when we harvest our maize</u>.
A. adjective clause, qualifying 'time'
B. adverb clause, modifying 'this'
C. noun clause, in apposition to 'time'
D. adverb clause, modifying 'is'

END OF QUESTION PAPER

SAMPLE COMPOSITION

Imagine that you had an interesting school trip to a game reserve. Write a composition entitled **An unforgettable trip to a game reserve**.

In your composition include the following points:

Paragraph 1

- who organized the trip
- when the trip took place
- who you went there with
- why the trip was made

Paragraph 2

- how you travelled to the game reserve
- who welcomed you at the game reserve
- **three** interesting things you saw at the game reserve

Paragraph 3

- **two** lessons you learnt from the trip
- why the trip is unforgettable

AN UNFORGETTABLE TRIP TO A GAME RESERVE

I want to tell you about an unforgettable trip to a game reserve. Our patron organised the trip. The trip took place on 21st July, 2003. I went there with my club members. The trip was made because our patron wanted us to see animals.

We travelled to the game reserve by bus. The manager welcomed us at the game reserve. Three interesting things I saw at the game reserve were animals, trees and waterfall.

Two lessons I learnt from the trip are that it is good to care for wild animals and that wild animals attract a lot of tourists. The trip is unforgettable because it was my first time to go to a game reserve. This is all I wanted to tell you about an unforgettable trip to a game reserve.

SAMPLE BUSINESS LETTER

Imagine that you want to visit the airport. Write a letter to the General Manager of Airport Development Limited, P. O Box 1320, Lilongwe. In your letter request permission for your class to visit Kamuzu International Airport. In your letter include the following points:

Paragraph 1

- date and time you want to visit the airport
- number of people who will be in the group

Paragraph 2

- purpose of the visit
- other areas to visit at the airport

Paragraph 3

- a request for a reply to your letter

Kambilonjo Primary School
Post Office Box 11
Kaloga
Ntcheu

23rd April, 2016.

The General Manager
Airport Development Limited
Post office Box 1320
Lilongwe

Dear Sir,

REQUEST FOR AN EDUCATIONAL VISIT

I would like to request for permission for our class to visit the airport. I want to visit the airport on thirty first May two thousand and sixteen at nine o'clock in the morning. The number of people who will be in the group is fifteen.

The purpose for the visit is to see how airplanes fly and land. Other areas to visit at the airport should be the control tower, kitchen and passengers' lounge.

I will be grateful when my request is considered favourably. This is all I wanted to request for an educational visit.

Yours faithfully,

Chimwemwe Banda.

SAMPLE FRIENDLY LETTER

Imagine that you bought a pair of shoes which you like most. Write a letter to your aunt who lives far from you to tell her about your pair of shoes. In your letter you may include the following information.

Paragraph 1

- What the colour of your pair of shoes is
- When you bought your pair of shoes
- What the size of your pair of shoes is

Paragraph 2

- How much you bought your pair of shoes for
- Where you bought your pair of shoes

Paragraph 3

- How you care for your pair of shoes
- Why you like your pair of shoes

Kambilonjo Primary School
Post Office Box 23
Ntcheu

23rd December, 2016.

Dear Aunt Annie,

I want to tell you about my pair of shoes. The colour of my pair of shoes is green. I bought my pair of shoes on 20th April, 2015. The size of my pair of shoes is eight.

I bought my pair of shoes for five thousand kwacha. I bought my pair of shoes at Chinamwali Market in Zomba.

I care for my pair of shoes by washing and storing in safe place. I like my pair of shoes because it is durable and beautiful. This is all I wanted to tell you about my pair of shoes.

Your niece,

Chikondi.

SAMPLE SPEECH

Imagine you have been asked to make speech on an open day about the transmission and prevention of HIV/AIDS. Include the following points in the speech:

Paragraph 1

- Describe HIV and AIDS

Paragraph 2

- How HIV and AIDS is spread

Paragraph 3

- How HIV and AIDS is prevented

SPREAD AND PREVENTION OF HIV AND AIDS.

The Headteacher

The School Committee Chairperson

The Village Heads

All leaders gathered here

My fellow learners

Ladies and gentlemen

It gives me a lot of pleasure to stand in front of you to make a speech on behalf of my fellow learners. In my speech, I will dwell much on how HIV and AIDS is spread and prevented.

HIV and AIDS is a deadly disease. Of course, other diseases are also deadly but HIV and AIDS is the most deadly disease because it is a multitude of diseases. On top of that, HIV and AIDS has no cure.

HIV and AIDS is spread in different ways. The most popular way of contracting this disease is through unprotected sexual intercourse. There are other ways in which HIV and AIDS is also spread. For instance, sharing of sharp objects such as razor blades and ear-piercing needles.

HIV and AIDS is preventable. So I would like to share with you some of the ways in which we can prevent HIV and AIDS. The most effective way is abstaining from sexual activities. The second one is by being faithful to one sexual partner and the last one is by using condoms during sex. My fellow learners, let us abstain from sexual intercourse in order to have a generation free of HIV and AIDS which will contribute to the development of our country.

Ladies and gentlemen, I thank you for your attention.

SAMPLE REPORT

Imagine that you witnessed a fire accident at your school which destroyed head teacher's office. The police have asked you to give them information on the accident.

In your report include the following points.

Paragraph 1

- Where the fire accident happened
- What caused the fire
- Where you were at the time the fire started

Paragraph 2

- What the headteacher was doing at the time the fire started
- What **two** helpful things you did during the accident

Paragraph 3

- **Two** things which were burnt by the fire
- **Two** problems that the accident has caused to your school

Date: 21st September, 2019

From: Sean Banda, Kambilonjo Primary School, Post Office Box 59 Nsanje

To: The Office In-Charge, Mphate Police Station, Post Office Box 12, Ntcheu

Subject: FIRE ACCIDENT

I would like to report on fire accident at my school. The accident happened on 23rd August, 2019 at nine o'clock in the morning. Electric fault caused the fire. I was mopping in the staffroom with my friends when the fire started.

The head teacher was addressing the school management committee under a mango tree when the fire started. During the accident, I screamed for help, then I managed to rescue three cartons of English books for standard three.

Head teacher's file and a sewing machine were burnt by the fire. The fire accident has caused several problems. Firstly, some teachers' particulars are missing. Secondly, Support Mother Groups are failing to make sanitary pads.

I hope you will treat this problem seriously.

Sean Banda.

(Source, 2016 MANEB)

COMPREHENSION QUESTIONS – HOW TO ANSWER THEM EFFECTIVELY

Comprehension reading requires the reader to understand a certain part of a passage or a paragraph.

The main purpose of comprehension reading is to understand the meaning that the given passage implies and try to answer questions accordingly.

Answering comprehension questions is not an easy task and many students often wonder on "how to answer comprehension question more effectively"

There are many reasons why students feel this way while doing comprehension questions.

1. One of the main reasons is that most of the students are so familiarised with an easy level of reading comprehension questions that they easily get flustered when they see passages that have a harder vocabulary and meaning.
2. Most students fail to understand the language and hence they lose interest in studying for such answers. But in reality, with proper practice and hard work one can easily conquer comprehension questions and they can be used to gain marks easily in a competitive exam.

HOW TO ATTEMPT COMPREHENSION PASSAGES?

A comprehension test comprises a passage which needs to be read well and the questions provided below it answered.

As the base of the answers relies on the passage, it is very important to craft your answers effectively by analysing the given passage properly.

- Do not use outside knowledge
- Make logical guesses
- Review the answer at least twice
- Always read the instructions carefully
- Always go through the questions first

HOW TO ANSWER COMPREHENSION QUESTIONS EFFECTIVELY?

When attempting comprehension questions, it is very important to take time and read the passage carefully. It is a very essential step that you need to follow in the initial stage.

Here are few guidelines for answering comprehension question:

- Try to link the question to your answer
- Never provide your opinion as answers, base your answer on facts
- The passage will never be so easy, so it is vital that you connect all the links together

- Craft your answers clearly, with perfection
- Never move out from the original question, answer to it precisely

Here are a few tips and tricks that you could make use of to conquer your fear of attending comprehension questions and enable you to answer comprehension questions satisfactorily and effectively.

Nine tips:

1. Try to understand the reading passage

   - This is one of the most common reasons that many students complain about. Keep in mind that it is not expected of every student to understand all the lines and words of the given paragraph. No one is expecting you to study all the lines and paragraphs and understand each and every sentence.
   - Try to understand the summary of the paragraph given and try to understand what meaning it is implying to. Though, it may seem contradictory but when simply put, just try to eliminate all the common words, sentences and phrases and understand the true meaning of the given paragraph. Try to keep focus and attention on the keywords and the turning points of the paragraph. This helps you to understand the questions even better and makes it easier for you to answer.

2. Utilise your strengths

   - One of the most important things that a student should do is to exploit their strengths while answering a comprehension question. This helps them to save time and answer questions more effectively.
   - One of the many methods that most students use is to first read the passage completely. This allows them to get an idea what the passage is about and they can be familiarised with the meaning of the passage given. But this method is not comfortable for some students, as they get confused about which keywords they should focus on and there is a chance that they might even forget the important keywords and end up reading the whole passage again.
   - Another method that one can use to save time is using the "**down to top**" method. Here, students can first read through the questions given and then read the paragraph so that this can allow them to get the necessary answers required for the given questions.
   - This saves time, since the students are familiarized with questions first instead of diving into the passage itself. This also gives the students the fair advantage since they can know how to answer the questions. Try to select any one of these methods that suits your taste and requirements.

3. Managing the time given

   - Time is also an important factor while answering comprehension questions. One of the most said complaints by students is that they didn't get enough time to answers that they knew of.
   - The main reason for this problem is that most of the students spend a lot of time reading through the passage questions, that they forget to allocate time for all the other sections of the exam paper.

- Keep in mind that competitive examinations not only test your knowledge but they also test your ability to manage time and they test your reading and writing skills when subjected to a time strict limit.
- To avoid panicking and struggling to answer the questions at the last minute, one of the best methods that a student can follow is to allocate a certain amount of time for each section of the exam.
- This can be done by dividing the total exam time given, depending on the difficulty level of each section provided in the exam
- Also, to help you manage time even more, try to answer as many practice papers as you can. This also gives an idea on your performance and gives you an insight on how well you perform under pressure during an exam.

4. Practice more

- To perform better at comprehension question, one of the best methods that students can use it to practice a lot of mock questions and attempt to answer as many practice papers as possible.
- One of the main reasons why many students fail to perform better at answering comprehension questions is that, a majority of them are reluctant to do practice papers at home. There might be many underlying factors such as the tough vocabulary and many students find themselves struggling to understand the meaning of the passage given.
- Through proper practice and hard work try to overcome your fears and turn them into your strengths. This will help you to face questions more confidently and effectively.

5. Upgrade your vocabulary

- Having poor vocabulary can be very disadvantageous for you, especially when attending competitive exams, which are heavily based upon time management.
- Having a good vocabulary means that it becomes easier for the student to understand the questions and it enables them to understand the meaning that the given passage is trying to imply.
- There are many ways in which one could improve and upgrade their vocabulary.

    i. Try reading English newspapers daily and take notice of the various vocabulary and words that they use
    ii. Try to use flashcards or take help from various vocabulary books present in the market. Also try to learn a given amount of words every day. This will increase your vocabulary and also encourages you to explore more new words.
    iii. Always write down new words and terms that you come across during your daily life. This might be from reading a book or while watching a film, listening to music and so on. Then try to revise and go through the words learned periodically for effective results.

6. Understand the level of the questions

- While attending comprehension questions, keep in mind that the level of comprehension questions can vary a lot.
- Comprehension questions used at school level vary between easy and intermediate level.

- We cannot compromise with the difficulty level of the question, but we compromise our understanding capability. So, to tackle such questions, there are various methods that we can follow.

  These include:
  i. Improving one's vocabulary and understanding of words and terms
  ii. Practice more and more comprehension questions
  iii. Try to read from a wide range of articles varying in fields such as arts, science, politics, general knowledge, sports and so on.

7. Try to have a good reading speed

- One way to beat the clock while attending competitive exams, especially while attempting comprehension questions, is to speed up reading thoroughly and effectively.
- For effective speed reading, try to understand all the important keywords and then focus on them while trying to understand the meaning of the given passage.
- This will give you an idea on what the passage is about and will also help you to provide satisfactory answers to the questions asked about the passage provided.
- While searching for keywords try to use a pen and mark the words that you find are important and are an essential part of the passage given.

8. Try not to rely on outside knowledge
   - While attending an advanced reading comprehension, try not to make answers and assumptions that are not included within the passage topic. If you fail to do so, you can easily lose marks during competitive exams.
   - Just rely on whatever information is given in the passage and attempt questions by giving answers that are mentioned in the passage only.
   - Don't jump into conclusions while answering questions, this gives off an impression that you have poorly understood the meaning of the passage.
   - Try not to include your own version of answers. Try to stick to the information that is mentioned only in the passage itself and not on your knowledge and facts.

9. Try not to be flustered
   - Another factor that you should keep in mind while attending a comprehension question is to have a relaxed state of mind and take your time in understanding the meaning of the passage given.
   - When you come across an uncertain word or when you see a complex word, try not to get flustered (confused) and tensed just because you do not know its meaning.
   - The best method in which you can control being tensed is to be well prepared with questions in accordance with the difficulty level of the questions being asked
   - Whenever you feel uncomfortable and tensed, try to close your eyes for a few minutes and concentrate on what you are doing. Try to keep your mind calm and silent for a while.
   - This will help you to focus on your task and hence provide you with the necessary encouragement and support needed to answer the questions.
   - Practising a lot of questions under a fixed time limit will also help you to perform better while answering comprehension questions.

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